

# **Seniors United Now**

The Voice of Seniors in Alberta

March 31, 2026

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## **RE: Concerns Regarding Budget 2026 Impacts on Alberta Seniors**

We are writing to express our profound concern on behalf of all Alberta Seniors regarding the changes to the Alberta Seniors Benefit and caregiver tax credits outlined in Budget 2026 and recently highlighted in the March 3rd CBC report.

As the province grapples with a \$9.4 billion deficit, the decision to reduce the income threshold for the Alberta Seniors Benefit by 9% is a distressing development. By lowering the cutoff for single seniors to \$32,690 and couples to \$53,800, your government is effectively stripping up to \$328 per month from an estimated 8,000 of our most vulnerable citizens. Furthermore, the consolidation of the Caregiver Tax Credit will see approximately 16,500 Albertans lose a \$1,000 credit at a time when the cost of living particularly in energy and insurance continues to outpace fixed incomes.

We find the rationale provided that Alberta was an outlier and these cuts merely align us with the averages of other jurisdictions like New Brunswick to be deeply inconsistent with this government's core philosophy. This administration has consistently argued that Alberta is unique and requires 'Made-in-Alberta' solutions that reflect our specific economic realities. To suddenly pivot to a "race to the middle" based on national averages, rather than addressing the actual needs of Albertans, is a disappointing departure from that principle.

Minister, we must ask: Is balancing the provincial books on the backs of the elderly a sign of a wise, sustainable government, or is it a short-sighted measure that will ultimately increase the burden on our healthcare system and non-profit sectors? Reducing the independence of seniors today only guarantees higher public costs tomorrow.

We would like to request a meeting with you, along with the individuals copied on this letter, to discuss the real-world impact of these changes and to explore alternatives that do not compromise the dignity and security of Alberta's seniors.

Thanking you in advance for your prompt response.

Sincerely,

*Wayne Sorenson*

Wayne Sorenson  
President, Seniors United Now

CC:  
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